



On the Gamestation CD

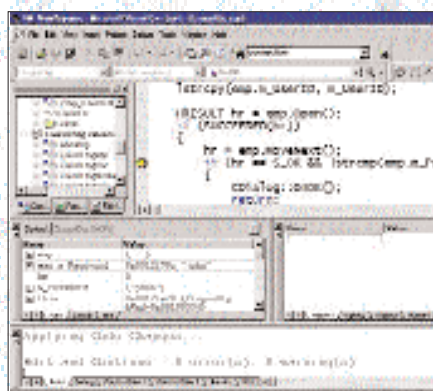
Game editing toolkits like Dark Basic, 3D Game Maker, level editors like Worldcraft, Quake3Radiant, game codes for *Quake III* and *Quake III Team Arena*, and 3D modelling and animation tools such as MilkShape 3D, gmax v1.1, and 3D Game Studio among others.

itself. Some mods are so different from the original version of the game that they become 'Total Conversions' (TC) and bear no resemblance to the original product. *Half-Life's Counter-Strike*, *Quake III's Rocket Arena*, *Quake II's Jailbreak* and *Quake III Rally* are some of best examples of such work.

Almost every game these days allows you to create new extensions for it, there's something out there for everyone. But the best pad to start off from would be the 'the big three'—the *Quake* series, *Unreal Tournament*, and *Half-Life*. All of them have seen a huge popularity in the modding, mapping and modelling scene. Of late, *Serious Sam* has also emerged as a popular mod development platform.

Compile as you are

Making a mod requires some level of programming knowledge; in fact, mods are good teaching tools to learn programming from. The language of choice for programmers is usually C or C++, so you will be able to find a wealth of resources and help. You should pick up some advanced books for reference. There are also a number of tutorials available on the Web for learning C and C++ that can help in supplementing what you learn from books.



Programming mods in Visual C++

Microsoft Visual C++ has a powerful development environment that will make things easier for you, and there's no other compiler better suited to developing Windows applications.

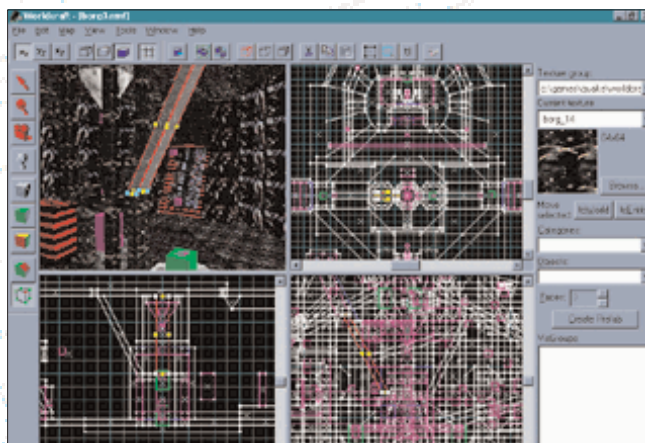
There are a large number of compilers available, including many free ones. Bloodshed is an awesome IDE (Integrated Development Environment) for beginners. It has everything you need to start out and is completely free. It can compile as quickly as Visual C++ or Borland, and is suitable for beginners.

Once you have the tools, you need to download the source code to work with. Each game has a different way by which you can tinker with it. There are actually two types of code that an editing community may see: game code (which allows you to make mods) and source code (engine code, networking code, etc—basically, if you had this you could rebuild a game from scratch).

You would either need to tamper with the game code (*Quake III*) or write high level scripts (*Unreal Tournament*) to create your own custom version of the game. Some games don't require any downloads; you simply work with the files packaged

within the game (*Unreal Tournament*). For almost every game that can be 'modded', there are extensive tutorials available on the Net that show you how to do so. Code 3 Arena (www.planetquake.com/code3arena) is an excellent resource for *Quake III* editing, and it teaches you everything you wanted to know about programming *Quake III* mods.

When you begin writing a mod you should start small. Don't plan to write a TC from the very start. If you set goals that are too hard to reach, you'll get frustrated in the process of working towards them. It is much better to set a series of small goals and work towards each one in turn. Start with a simple idea that could be expanded into a larger game. A simple gun or gameplay modification would be a great way to begin.



Worldcraft Editor: Design your own levels for Half-Life

Quake II goes Open Source

id Software released the source code for *Quake II* at the end of 2001 under the 'GNU Public License'. The *Quake I* code was released a year prior to that under the same license. This license, amongst other things, allows you to use the source code and the binaries of *Quake* and *Quake II* for commercial and non-commercial purposes.

Simply put, it means that if you have made a game without using any of id Software's other intellectual

properties (such as textures, models, sounds and so on), you are now legally allowed to sell your work. You can do anything you want with the code, including sell your new version. The catch is that if you distribute new binary versions, you are required to make the entire source code available for free to everyone.

All of the *Quake II* data files remain copyrighted and licensed under the original terms. So you cannot redistribute data from the original game, but if you make a true total conversion, you can create a standalone game based on this code.

